

Product Requirements Document (PRD)

Automotive Service CRM Platform

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1. Executive Summary

This document describes the requirements for an internal **CRM platform** for an automotive repair and parts business. The platform serves two connected purposes:

- Client and order management** — a single place to capture every client, their vehicle, the parts/repair they requested, and the live status of that job, so any team member who logs in sees the same up-to-date picture.
- Internal accountability** — a shared workspace where every employee manages their own roles, KPIs, bottlenecks and weekly tasks, where anyone can assign work to anyone, where the whole team can see each other's progress, and where peers grade each other on deliverables and communication against a company-wide KPI target.

A defining feature is **proactive client communication**: the system automatically reminds the team (and can send the clients themselves) status updates on a fixed daily schedule, prompts a monthly check-in on every client, and uses **AI to draft apology messages** when a job is delayed or fails, tailored to the specific reason it wasn't completed.

2. Goals and Objectives

#	Goal	Why it matters
G1	Single source of truth for all clients, vehicles and orders	No more scattered notes; everyone sees the same status
G2	Real-time, shared visibility of job status (pending / in progress / completed / failed)	Reduces "where is my car?" calls and internal confusion
G3	Proactive, scheduled client communication (daily 6 PM updates, monthly check-ins)	Drives customer delight and repeat business
G4	Lower the effort of writing difficult messages via AI-drafted apologies	Consistent, empathetic communication even when things go wrong
G5	Team-wide accountability for tasks and KPIs	Everyone sees who is doing what and how it's going
G6	Continuous peer feedback on performance	Surfaces strengths and bottlenecks early

Success metrics

- 100% of active jobs have a status that was updated within the last 24 hours.
- $\geq 90\%$ of clients receive a status update by the daily cut-off time.
- Monthly check-in completed for $\geq 95\%$ of active clients.
- Every employee has current-week tasks with statuses logged.
- Average peer-review participation ≥ 1 review per employee per review cycle.

3. Scope

In scope (v1)

- Manual client/order/vehicle data entry
- Shared client dashboard with live status
- Reminder + scheduled-update engine (daily updates, monthly check-ins)
- Customer feedback capture
- AI-generated apology message drafting
- Employee self-onboarding and profiles (roles, KPIs, bottlenecks)
- Weekly tasks from daily assignments with status
- Cross-team task visibility and assignment
- Peer performance grading

- Company-wide KPI target board

Out of scope (v1 — candidate for later phases)

- Automated invoicing / payment processing
 - Inventory/parts procurement automation (manual availability flag only in v1)
 - Native mobile apps (responsive web first)
 - Public-facing client login portal (clients receive messages, but do not log in, in v1)
 - Accounting integrations
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4. Users and Roles

The platform is used internally by the whole team; **clients do not log in** in v1 (they receive messages). All logged-in users can see the full client dashboard and the full team accountability dashboard, by design, for transparency.

Role	Description	Typical permissions
Admin / Owner	Sets up the platform, manages users, sets company KPI targets	Full access, including user management and deletion
Manager	Oversees jobs and team performance	All client + team data; can assign tasks to anyone; can configure reminders
Service Advisor	Front-desk; creates clients and orders, talks to customers	Create/edit clients & orders; send updates; log feedback
Technician	Performs repairs; updates job status	View clients; update status on assigned jobs; manage own tasks
Parts Staff	Manages parts availability flags	Update parts availability; view related orders

Note on transparency: A core requirement is that *everyone who logs in can view the client dashboard and everyone's tasks/status*. Roles above mainly govern who can **edit** what; **viewing** the client list, job statuses, and team task board is open to all authenticated users.

A full editable permissions matrix is in **Appendix A**.

5. Functional Requirements

The requirements are grouped into modules. Each requirement has an ID (e.g. **CLT-01**) for traceability.

Module A — Authentication & User Management

ID	Requirement
AUTH-01	Any employee can self-register an account (name, email, password) from the dashboard sign-up screen.
AUTH-02	On first login, the user completes their profile: role(s), KPIs, current bottlenecks (free-text), and is taken to the dashboard.
AUTH-03	Secure login with email + password; password reset via email.
AUTH-04	Admin can view, edit, deactivate, or delete any user account.
AUTH-05	(Recommended) New self-registered accounts may require admin approval before gaining edit rights, to prevent unauthorized access. <i>[Open question — see §11]</i>

Module B — Client & Order Management (Client Side)

ID	Requirement
CLT-01	Authorized users can manually create a client record .
CLT-02	Client record captures: Full name, Contact (phone, email, WhatsApp), Address (optional) .
CLT-03	Each client can have one or more vehicles . A vehicle captures: Car make, Car model, Car year, registration/plate (optional), VIN (optional), color (optional), mileage (optional) .
CLT-04	Each client can have one or more orders / job requests . An order captures: Order request details (description of repair or part needed), parts list, the linked vehicle, date received, expected completion date, assigned technician .
CLT-05	Each part/item on an order has an availability flag : <i>Available / Not available / On order</i> .
CLT-06	Each order has a status : <i>Pending, In Progress, Completed, Failed, On Hold</i> (configurable list).
CLT-07	When a status is set to <i>Failed</i> or <i>On Hold</i> , the user is prompted to record a reason (this reason feeds the AI apology feature — see Module F).

ID	Requirement
CLT-08	Full edit history / activity log per client and per order (who changed what, when).
CLT-09	Search and filter clients by name, contact, vehicle, status, assigned technician, or date.
Suggested status definitions: • Pending — order received, work not yet started. • In Progress — actively being worked on. • Completed — work finished, ready for/handed to client. • Failed — could not be completed (records a reason). • On Hold — paused (e.g. awaiting parts), records a reason.	

Module C — Shared Client Dashboard

ID	Requirement
DASH-01	Every logged-in user can view the client dashboard.
DASH-02	Dashboard shows a list of all clients with key columns: client name, vehicle (make/model/year), order summary, status, parts availability, expected completion, assigned tech, last update time.
DASH-03	Status is shown with clear colour-coded badges (e.g. Pending = amber, In Progress = blue, Completed = green, Failed = red, On Hold = grey).
DASH-04	Clicking a client opens a detail view : all their vehicles, all parts/orders, full status history, feedback, and communication log.
DASH-05	Dashboard supports quick filters (e.g. "Show me everything that's Failed", "Due today", "Parts not available").
DASH-06	A summary strip at the top shows counts: total active jobs, # pending, # in progress, # completed this week, # failed, # awaiting parts.

Module D — Reminders & Scheduled Updates

This module covers both *internal reminders to the team* and *outbound updates to customers*.

ID	Requirement
REM-01	Daily customer update reminder: every active client should have a status update sent by a configurable cut-off time (default 6:00 PM, West Africa Time). The system surfaces a daily checklist of clients still needing an update before the cut-off.
REM-02	The team can either (a) manually approve/send each update, or (b) enable auto-send of a templated update at the cut-off time. <i>[Choice — see §11]</i>
REM-03	Updates can be sent via SMS, WhatsApp, and/or email (channel per client based on their contact preference).
REM-04	Update messages use templates with merge fields (client name, vehicle, status, expected completion, next step) and can be edited before sending.
REM-05	Monthly client check-in reminder: the system reminds the team to routinely check on every client once a month (configurable cadence), creating a task/notification per client when the check-in is due.
REM-06	Per-job reminders: users can set a one-off or recurring reminder on any order (e.g. "follow up on parts in 2 days").
REM-07	All sent communications are logged on the client record (channel, timestamp, content, sender).
REM-08	A reminders/notifications centre lists everything due today, overdue, and upcoming, per user and team-wide.

Scheduling engine note (for the build team): This requires a background scheduler (e.g. a daily cron/queue job running at the cut-off time and a monthly job). The system must respect time zone (WAT) and handle clients with no preferred channel gracefully (fall back to a default channel or flag for manual handling).

Module E — Customer Feedback ("Customer Delight")

ID	Requirement
FB-01	Authorized users can log customer delight feedback against a client/order: a rating (e.g. 1–5 or thumbs) plus free-text comments.
FB-02	Feedback can optionally be captured directly from the customer via a shareable feedback link/form (no login required) tied to the order. <i>[Optional for v1]</i>
FB-03	Feedback is visible on the client detail view and aggregated on a feedback summary (average rating, recent comments, trend).

ID	Requirement
FB-04	Low ratings can trigger an internal alert/task to follow up.

Module F — AI-Assisted Apology Messages

This is a distinctive, AI-powered feature for when a job is delayed or fails.

ID	Requirement
AI-01	When an order is <i>Failed</i> , <i>On Hold</i> , or otherwise delayed past its expected completion, the user can click " Draft apology ".
AI-02	The AI generates a personalised, empathetic apology message using the recorded reason for non-completion (from CLT-07), the client's name, the vehicle, and the new expected timeline.
AI-03	The user can choose the tone (e.g. formal / warm / brief), channel (SMS/WhatsApp/email — affects length), and language , then edit before sending .
AI-04	The draft is never sent automatically — it always requires human review and approval before sending.
AI-05	Generated drafts and the final sent version are logged on the client record.
AI-06	(Optional) The AI can also draft routine status updates and monthly check-in messages , not only apologies.

Implementation note: This uses the Anthropic Claude API. The prompt should include the failure/delay reason, client name, vehicle details, original vs. new completion date, and chosen tone — and instruct the model to produce a concise, sincere apology with a clear next step and revised timeline. Drafts must always be human-approved (AI-04). Avoid sending any sensitive client data beyond what's needed.

Module G — Employee Workspace (Internal Side)

ID	Requirement
EMP-01	Each employee has a profile they can edit: name, role(s), photo (optional), and personal KPIs (free-text or structured targets).

ID	Requirement
EMP-02	Each employee can manually log current bottlenecks (what's blocking them), visible to managers and the team.
EMP-03	Each employee maintains weekly tasks , which are built from daily assignments . A task captures: title, description, day/date, due date, assignee, and status (<i>Pending / In Progress / Completed / Failed</i> — same configurable set).
EMP-04	Tasks can be created by the employee for themselves or assigned to anyone by any authorized user (see Module H).
EMP-05	A weekly view rolls daily tasks into the week so progress is visible at a glance; tasks carry over if not completed, with status preserved.

Module H — Task Assignment & Accountability Dashboard

ID	Requirement
ACC-01	Any user can assign a task to any other user (or to themselves), setting title, details, due date and priority.
ACC-02	A team task board shows everyone's tasks and their completion status , viewable by all logged-in users (the explicit accountability requirement).
ACC-03	The board can be filtered/grouped by person, status, day/week, or priority, and shown as a list or Kanban (Pending → In Progress → Completed/Failed).
ACC-04	Each person has completion stats (e.g. % of this week's tasks completed) visible on the board.
ACC-05	Assignees are notified when a task is assigned to them, and when a task is overdue.
ACC-06	Overdue / failed tasks are highlighted to keep the team accountable.

Module I — Peer Performance Reviews

ID	Requirement
PERF-01	Everyone can grade everyone's performance . A review captures scores for Deliverables and Communication level (e.g. 1-5 each), plus optional comments.

ID	Requirement
PERF-02	Additional configurable criteria can be added (e.g. Teamwork, Timeliness).
PERF-03	Reviews are organised by cycle (e.g. weekly or monthly).
PERF-04	Each employee's profile shows their average scores per criterion and trends over time.
PERF-05	Configurable visibility: choose whether reviews are anonymous or attributed , and who can see individual vs. aggregate scores. <i>[Open question — see §11]</i>

Module J — Company KPI Target Board

ID	Requirement
KPI-01	Admin/Manager can manually input company-wide KPI targets (e.g. "Jobs completed per week: 40", "Avg customer rating ≥ 4.5 ", "On-time update rate $\geq 90\%$ ").
KPI-02	The company KPI targets are displayed on the main dashboard for everyone to see .
KPI-03	Where data exists (e.g. completed jobs, average rating), the board shows current actual vs. target with a simple progress indicator. KPIs without automatic data can be updated manually.
KPI-04	KPI targets can be edited and have an effective period (e.g. for this month/quarter).

6. Key User Stories

- *As a service advisor*, I can add a new client and their car (make/model/year) and the part they need, mark whether the part is available, and set the job to Pending — so the whole team can see it.
- *As a technician*, I can update a job to In Progress or Completed, and if it Failed I record why — so the front desk knows what to tell the client.
- *As any team member*, by 6 PM I can see which clients still need an update today and send (or approve) those updates.
- *As a manager*, when a job is delayed I can click "Draft apology", let the AI write an empathetic message based on the delay reason, edit it, and send it.

- *As any team member*, I can open the dashboard and see every client's status and every colleague's tasks and completion rate.
 - *As any team member*, I can assign a task to a colleague and grade their deliverables and communication this week.
 - *As the owner*, I can set the company KPI targets and everyone sees them on the dashboard.
 - *As the system*, once a month I remind the team to check in on each client.
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7. Data Model (High-Level)

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User (id, name, email, password_hash, roles[], kpis, bottlenecks, photo)
└─< Task (id, title, description, date, due_date, status, priority,
         assignee_id, created_by_id)
└─< PerformanceReview (id, reviewer_id, reviewee_id, cycle,
                       deliverables_score, communication_score, comments)

Client (id, name, phone, email, whatsapp, address, preferred_channel)
└─< Vehicle (id, client_id, make, model, year, plate, vin, color, mileage)
└─< Order (id, client_id, vehicle_id, description, expected_date,
          status, status_reason, assigned_tech_id, received_date)
      └─< Part (id, order_id, name, availability_status)
└─< Feedback (id, client_id, order_id, rating, comments, created_by)
└─< Communication (id, client_id, channel, content, sent_at, sender_id, type)

Reminder (id, type[daily_update|monthly_checkin|custom], target_ref,
          due_at, recurrence, status)

CompanyKPI (id, name, target_value, current_value, unit, period)

ActivityLog (id, entity_type, entity_id, action, user_id, timestamp)
```

8. Non-Functional Requirements

Area	Requirement
Platform	Responsive web app (works on desktop and mobile browsers) in v1.
Performance	Dashboard loads core data in < 2 seconds for typical volumes.
Security	Encrypted passwords, role-based access control, HTTPS, audit logs. Client contact data treated as sensitive.

Area	Requirement
Reliability	Scheduled jobs (daily 6 PM, monthly check-in) must run reliably; failures are logged and retried.
Time zone	All scheduling defaults to West Africa Time (WAT) ; configurable.
Messaging	Integrate with SMS/WhatsApp/email providers; handle delivery failures gracefully.
Auditability	All edits and communications are logged with user + timestamp.
Backups	Regular automated database backups.

9. Permissions Summary

See **Appendix A** for the full matrix. Headline rule: **all authenticated users can VIEW the client dashboard, the team task board, performance summaries, and the company KPI board.** Edit/admin actions are role-restricted.

10. Suggested Delivery Phases

Phase	Focus	Includes
Phase 1 — Core	Get data in and visible	Auth & self-registration (AUTH), Client/Order/Vehicle entry (CLT), Shared client dashboard (DASH), basic status
Phase 2 — Team	Internal accountability	Employee profiles & tasks (EMP), Task assignment & team board (ACC), Company KPI board (KPI)
Phase 3 — Communication	Proactive client contact	Reminders & scheduled updates incl. 6 PM daily + monthly check-in (REM), Feedback (FB)
Phase 4 — Intelligence	Smart assistance	AI apology drafting (AI), peer performance reviews (PERF), KPI actual-vs-target automation

11. Open Questions & Assumptions

- Auto-send vs. manual approval** for the daily 6 PM update — should the system send automatically or queue drafts for a person to approve? (REM-02)
- New-account approval** — can anyone self-register and immediately edit data, or does an admin approve new accounts first? (AUTH-05)

- 3. **Peer reviews anonymity** — should grades be anonymous or attributed, and who sees individual scores? (PERF-05)
- 4. **Do clients ever log in?** Assumed no for v1 (they receive messages only). Confirm.
- 5. **Messaging providers** — which SMS/WhatsApp/email services will be used? (affects cost and setup)
- 6. **KPI data sources** — which KPIs can be auto-calculated vs. manually updated?
- 7. **Languages** — should AI messages and templates support multiple languages?

Assumptions: Single workshop location in v1; West Africa Time; English as primary language; manual parts availability (no live inventory integration yet).

Appendix A — Permissions Matrix (editable starting point)

Capability	Admin	Manager	Service Advisor	Technician	Parts Staff
Manage users	✓	—	—	—	—
Create/edit clients & orders	✓	✓	✓	—	—
Update job status	✓	✓	✓	✓ (assigned)	—
Update parts availability	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
View client dashboard	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Send / approve client updates	✓	✓	✓	—	—
Configure reminders	✓	✓	—	—	—
Use AI apology drafting	✓	✓	✓	—	—
Create/assign tasks (to anyone)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
View team task board	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Grade peer performance	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Set company KPI targets	✓	✓	—	—	—
View company KPI board	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

✓ = allowed · — = not allowed (adjust to your team's preference)